DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 1

Logo designer

Profession 1 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A logo designer creates the mark and wordmark that identify a business, following a brief, research and a clear concept.

What professionals do every day

Runs client briefings, researches competitors, sketches concepts, builds vector logos, presents options with reasons and delivers the final file package.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Every business needs an identity customers recognise. A good logo is simple, memorable and works at small sizes and in one colour.

- Logos that look like the competition.
- Marks that fail at favicon size or in black and white.
- Brands with no clear reason behind the design.

Skills you need

- Typography and letterform basics.
- Vector drawing in Illustrator or Figma.
- Colour theory and contrast.
- Client briefing and presentation.
- Trademark awareness: check that a mark is not already in use.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Adobe Illustrator	Vector logos	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/illustrator.html
Figma	Vector drawing and presentations	Free starter	Paid plans	www.figma.com
Inkscape	Open-source vector editor	Free	Free	inkscape.org
Canva	Quick logo templates (less custom)	Free	Paid plans	www.canva.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Redraw existing simple shapes; learn the pen tool.

Intermediate	Design five logos for fictional businesses from a one-page brief.
Advanced	Build a full identity: primary, icon, one-colour and stacked versions, with usage rules.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Five marks for five fictional cafés.
- **Intermediate:** A wordmark for a tutoring brand.
- **Advanced:** A full identity kit for a fictional clinic.

Client-ready portfolio project

A complete logo identity for a fictional business: research summary, three directions, the final mark in five versions, a colour palette with contrast checks, and a usage guide.

Worked example

Worked example. A bakery brief: a loaf and a whisk merged into one shape. The idea is tested at 32 pixels and in black and white before the colour is chosen.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Brand palette and logo test

Business problem: A fictional bakery needs a palette for its logo and website, checked for accessibility.

Steps

1. Choose three brand colours and a neutral.
2. Check each text pair with the contrast tool.
3. Test the logo at 32 pixels and in one colour.
4. Write a usage note.

Expected output: A palette with pass or fail results and a logo test sheet.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Check every text colour against the background it sits on. The ink-on-white and ink-on-soft pairs pass AA. Brand purple on white scores 5.26:1, so it passes AA for body text. Re-run the check whenever a colour changes.

PYTHON

```
from contrast import contrast_ratio, passes_aa
palette = {"ink": "#1D1640", "brand": "#6C4CF5", "soft": "#F3F0FF", "white": "#FFFFFF"}
text_pairs = [("ink", "white"), ("brand", "white"), ("ink", "soft")]
for fg, bg in text_pairs:
    print(fg, "on", bg, contrast_ratio(palette[fg], palette[bg]), "AA pass:",
passes_aa(palette[fg], palette[bg]))
```

Common mistakes

- Starting in the software before sketching.
- Using a font without checking its licence for commercial use.
- No small-size or one-colour test.
- Presenting one option instead of three.

Freelancing opportunities

- Logo and identity projects for start-ups and small firms.
- Rebrand projects.
- Briefs on freelance marketplaces: 'logo design', 'brand identity'. Present a process-led portfolio.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Adobe Illustrator tutorials
- Figma resource library

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.